

US political scientist, Robert Putnam, has an interest in public policy and social change. In his book *Bowling Alone*, he studies the links between society and the economy, especially in the US. The social networks in society, which he calls “social capital,” are a resource that he believes is dwindling in the modern world.

François Quesnay (1694–1774)

One of the first modern economists, François Quesnay was born in Méré, near Versailles, France. After studying medicine, he became a doctor in the King’s court at Versailles, but later devoted his time to economics, writing his *Tableau Économique*, one of the first descriptions of the workings of the economy, in 1758.

[David Ricardo \(1772–1823\)](#)

Joan Robinson (1903–1983)

One of the first successful female economists, Joan Robinson studied at Cambridge University, and after a period of traveling returned there to teach. There, she was influenced by [John Maynard Keynes](#), and developed his ideas into her own theories of monetary economics, as well as reviving interest in Marxian economics. A great traveler, she also pioneered ideas of economic development.

Dani Rodrik (1957–)

Turkish economist Dani Rodrik studied economics in the US, where he is presently a professor of International Political Economy at Harvard University, but he retains strong links with his native Turkey. He is most influential in the fields of economic development and international economics, where he has closely examined the wide-ranging social and economic effects of increased globalization, and governments’ responses to them.

Jeffrey Sachs (1954–)

Known for his work advising governments in Latin America and the former Communist countries of Eastern Europe and the Soviet Union in the 1980s and 90s, Jeffrey Sachs has more recently worked on issues of sustainable development and public health. He was born in Detroit, Michigan, and studied at Harvard University, where he also taught economics for more than 20 years. Since 2002 he has been director of the Earth Institute at Columbia University in New York.

Jean-Baptiste Say (1767–1832)

Best known for his description of supply and demand in the market, known as “Say’s Law,” French economist Jean-Baptiste Say was born in France, but finished his education in England. He worked as a merchant and later set up a cotton mill, but was also editor of a political magazine in Paris, popularizing the economic ideas of [Adam Smith](#).

Joseph Schumpeter (1883–1950)